

# Rising intensity, and what drives it

The PN's reading of Eurostat's greenhouse gas intensity figures, tested

## THE CLAIM

**“Malta is the only EU Member State which ... increased the intensity of greenhouse gas emissions from 2013 ...”**

Partit Nazzjonalista press release, signed by Eve Borg Bonello, 26 January 2026

It cites Eurostat (Malta +17%, EU –34%) and blames a lack of ambition on several fronts, among them, renewables.

Our translation of the Maltese release. Eurostat's 2024 values are estimates.

## VERDICT

# MISLEADING

*Eurostat's figure is right;  
the rise is airline fuel.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY  
SUPPORTED

NOT  
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

## MAIN RESULTS

### +14%

#### Only rise in the EU

Eurostat's indicator, 2013–2024 (+17% in January); EU –34%. 2024 is an estimate.

### 72%

#### Airline fuel bought abroad

Share of Malta's 2024 figure; firms resident in Malta are counted wherever they fly.

### –64%

#### Without air transport

Same indicator since 2013 (EU's 2nd-largest fall); a fall from every base year 2008–2023, –29.5% since 2016.

### –61%

#### Territorial inventory

Emissions in Malta per euro of GDP since 2013; a fall from every base year 2008–2023, –27% since 2016.

### +1.4%

#### With zero power-sector emissions

In 2024 the indicator would still be above 2013, so renewables cannot explain the rise.

## FAIR TO SAY

The PN quoted Eurostat's own headline correctly, and from base years 2014–2019 Malta's rise is larger (+19.5% to +97%). Malta's renewable shares are low (10.7% of electricity, the EU's lowest). The issue is what the figure counts.

## WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The PN's source for “third from last”.

☐ Which other “fronts” the PN had in mind.

☐ Which airline operations drive the series.

☐ Malta's reported 2024 accounts.